

0.0.1 To Janussoni

1. Then, the brahmin Janussoni visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, he exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin Janussoni said this to the Auspicious One:

2. Indeed we brahmins, O Master Gotama, usually make food offerings when performing memorial rites [believing] “May this food offering be of benefit to our departed relatives and blood relations. May our departed relatives and blood relations enjoy this food offering.” “Do our departed relatives and blood relations, O Master Gotama, truly benefit from this food offering? Do our departed relatives and blood relations truly enjoy this food offering?”

3. In a suitable place, O Brahmin, they benefit, not in an unsuitable place.

4. But what, O Master Gotama, is a suitable place? What is an unsuitable place?

5. Here, O Brahmin, a certain individual is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech,

a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. With the body's breakup after death, he arises in a lower world, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, in hell. Whichever is the nutriment of the hell beings, it is just that which he lives on, it is just that which he sustains himself with. This, O brahmin, is an unsuitable place where staying, he cannot benefit from that food offering.

6. Here, O Brahmin, a certain individual is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. With the body's breakup after death, he arises in an animal womb. Whichever is the nutriment of the animals, it is just that which he lives on, it is just that which he sustains himself with. This, O brahmin, is an unsuitable place where staying, he cannot benefit from that food offering.

7. Here, O Brahmin, a certain person is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. With the breakup of the body after death, he arises in compan-

ionship with human beings. Whichever is the nutriment of the human beings, it is just that which he lives on, it is just that which he sustains himself with. This, O brahmin, is an unsuitable place where staying, he cannot benefit from that food offering.

8. Here, O Brahmin, a certain person is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. With the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with devas. Whichever is the nutriment of the devas, it is just that which he lives on, it is just that which he sustains himself with. This, O brahmin, is an unsuitable place where staying, he cannot benefit from that food offering.

9. Here, O Brahmin, a certain individual is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. With the body's breakup after death, he arises in the realm of ghosts. Whichever is the nutriment of the beings in the realm of ghosts, it is just that which he lives on, it is just that which he sustains himself with.

Or else whichever [food] his friends, colleagues, relatives or blood relations offer, it is just that which he lives on, it is just that which he sustains himself with. This, O brahmin, is a suitable place where staying, he can benefit from that food offering.

10. “But if, O Master Gotama, our departed relative or blood relation has not arisen in that suitable place, who is it that enjoys the food offering?”

11. “Other departed relatives and blood relations who have arisen in that suitable place enjoy that food offering.”

12. “But if, O Master Gotama, our departed relative or blood relation has not arisen in that suitable place, and other departed relatives and blood relations have not arisen in that suitable place, who is it that enjoys the food offering?”

13. This is not possible, O Brahmin, it is inconceivable that in this long period [of samsara], that suitable place will be secluded from this, namely, “departed relatives and blood relations.” Nevertheless, O Brahmin, it is not fruitless for the giver too.

14. “Does the venerable Gotama speak of a possibility of [reaping the fruits of merits] even in unsuitable places?”

15. “Even in unsuitable places, O Brahmin, I do speak of that possibility.”

16. Here, O Brahmin, a certain individual is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. He is a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. With the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with elephants. At that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

17. As one, O Brahmin, who here in this world was a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view, so with the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with elephants. As one who here in this world was a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas, so at that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

18. Here, O Brahmin, a certain individual is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. He is a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. With the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with horses. At that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

19. As one, O Brahmin, who here in this world was a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view, so with the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with horses. As one who here in this world was a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas, so at that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

20. Here, O Brahmin, a certain individual is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech,

a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. He is a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. With the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with cows. At that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

21. As one, O Brahmin, who here in this world was a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view, so with the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with cows. As one who here in this world was a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas, so at that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

22. Here, O Brahmin, a certain individual is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. He is a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. With the breakup

of the body after death, he arises in companionship with dogs. At that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

23. As one, O Brahmin, who here in this world was a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view, so with the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with dogs. As one who here in this world was a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas, so at that place, he becomes a gainer of food, drinks, garland and various adornments.

24. Here, O Brahmin, a certain person is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. He is a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. With the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with human beings. At that place, he becomes a gainer of the five cords of human

sensual pleasures.

25. As one, O Brahmin, who here in this world was an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view, so with the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with human beings. As one who here in this world was a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas, so at that place, he becomes a gainer of the five cords of human sensual pleasures.

26. Here, O Brahmin, a certain person is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. He is a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. With the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with devas. At that place, he becomes a gainer of the five cords of divine sensual

pleasures.

27. As one, O Brahmin, who here in this world was an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view, so with the breakup of the body after death, he arises in companionship with devas. As one who here in this world was a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas, so at that place, he becomes a gainer of the five cords of divine sensual pleasures.

28. “It is marvellous, O Master Gotama. It is unprecedented, O Master Gotama, at any rate, O Master Gotama, it is just enough to give food offerings, enough to perform the memorial rites, in so far as for the giver too, it is not fruitless.

29. That is so, O Brahmin, that is so, O Brahmin. For the giver too, O Brahmin, it is not fruitless.

30. “Excellent, O Master Gotama! Excellent, O Master Gotama! Just as, O Master Gotama, one might set upright what has been overturned, or open up what has been

closed, or show a path to one who is lost, or bear an oil lamp in the darkness so that those with good eyesight can see forms, just so has the Dhamma been explained by the venerable Gotama in countless ways. I go, to the Auspicious Gotama, as refuge, and to the Dhamma, and to the Sangha of bhikkhus. May Master Gotama bear it in mind, that I am a lay disciple who has gone for refuge from today for as long as life lasts.”